up water and expand; this expansion causes an increase in the volume of the material itself or rock. This process is reversible and long, continued repetition of this process causes fatigue in the rocks and may lead to their disintegration. The volume changes in minerals due to hydration will also help in physical weathering through exfoliation and granular disintegration.

12. In weathering, oxidation means a combination of a mineral with oxygen to form oxides (rusting in case of iron) or hydroxides. Red soils appear red due to the presence of iron oxides. Oxidation occurs where there is ready access to the atmosphere and water. The minerals most involved in this process are iron, manganese, sulphur, etc. When oxidised minerals are placed in an environment where oxygen is absent, reduction takes place.
13. Burrowing and wedging by organisms like earthworms, rodents, etc., help in exposing the new surfaces to chemical attack and assists in the penetration of moisture and air. Human beings by disturbing vegetation, ploughing and cultivating soils, also help in mixing and creating new contacts between air, water and minerals in the earth materials.
14. With rise in temperature, every mineral expands and pushes against its neighbour and as temperature falls, a corresponding contraction takes place. As a result of diurnal changes in the temperatures, this internal movement among the mineral grains takes place regularly. This process is most effective in dry climates and high elevations where diurnal temperature changes are drastic.
15. According to CDT of Wegner, India, along with Madagascar, South America and Africa were part of Gondwanaland, which the only other mega continent apart from Laurasia. Wegner believed that equator wards drift was due to the interaction of forces of gravity, pole-fleeing force and buoyancy (ship floats in water due to buoyant force offered by water), and westwards due to tidal currents because of the earth's motion (earth rotates form west to east, so tidal currents act from east to west). This interpretation was not accepted by modern scholars and proposed Conventional Current Theory to explain the same.